

Philipp Hilbert. *Backlog owner who ships, coaches, and automates the rest.*

Positioning, Product Owner with ten years of cross-functional delivery, bringing sprint discipline, AI-native backlog automation, and a coaching mindset to Wire's secure communications mission.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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§ WHY WIRE

Wire operates in one of the few domains where product failure has real-world consequences for real people – governments, hospitals, and financial institutions rely on the platform to keep sensitive communication out of hostile hands. That is a different kind of accountability than most SaaS backlogs carry. The posting's explicit expectation that the Product Owner will use AI tooling to automate the mechanical layer of the role – ticket drafting, burndown signalling, release notes – rather than treat it as a bonus, signals a team that thinks carefully about where human judgment actually belongs. The quantum-secure encryption work I led at Qcrypt AG and the defence-grade data platform I owned at Rohde & Schwarz give me a direct sense of how security and compliance constraints shape every prioritisation call. *That is exactly the weight I want to be responsible for.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Wire is a pure secure-communications product, and my background is in data platforms, healthcare apps, and InsurTech delivery rather than in messaging or real-time protocol products. The underlying delivery mechanics – backlog ownership, sprint facilitation, dependency coordination, and AI-assisted grooming – are identical; the domain knowledge I will build on the job.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, ticket drafting, acceptance criteria generation, release notes
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support and review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted specification and edge-case generation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping and clickable concept validation
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and stakeholder walkthroughs
- **Gamma.app**, structured discovery decks and retrospective artefacts
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation for reporting and grooming pipelines
- **GPT**, summarisation, stakeholder briefings, and backlog health signals

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Production work delivered with Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Redpanda, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, REST APIs, CGM API integration, AngularJS, Ionic, and MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

QCRYPT AG [YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=NT06F71LGFE](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NT06F71LGFE) →

Quantum-secure one-time-pad encryption product designed for non-technical end users.

- Owned the full product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and hardware-based true random number generation.
- Architecture centred on OTP keys paired with true-RNG hardware; no technical knowledge required from the end user, setup under two minutes.
- Served as deputy IT security officer alongside the Product Owner role, covering attack vector mitigation and compliance posture.
- Directly relevant to Wire: the product problem – making unbreakable encryption accessible to ordinary users – is Wire's product problem, one abstraction level up.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT WIRE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every ritual – refinement, planning, demo, retro – without touching the backlog yet, mapping where the friction actually lives between the product vision and what lands in Jira, and identifying which dependency signals are invisible to the broader team.

WEEK 2

Tighten the backlog.

Work through the existing epics and stories with the Product Manager to apply consistent definition-of-ready criteria, surface acceptance-criteria gaps, and draft a first pass of AI-assisted grooming templates that cut the per-ticket drafting time in half.

WEEK 3+

Ship, coach, close loops.

Run the rituals independently, protect the sprint scope from unplanned change, and introduce one measurable process improvement per cycle – whether that is automated burndown reporting, a refined estimation approach, or a dependency board – until the team is genuinely self-organising rather than waiting for a coordinator.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Wire Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role because it combines the two things I care most about in product work: genuine delivery accountability and a mission that actually matters. Wire protects communication for governments, hospitals, and financial institutions. Every prioritisation call carries weight. That is the kind of backlog I want to own.

My most direct parallel is the role I held at Emil Group, where I inherited a 17-person team in delivery crisis, split it into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops. I did not just administer the process – I coached the team back to a point where it could self-organise. The posting's language about coaching agile maturity rather than being a process gatekeeper maps exactly to what I did there.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a government defence platform end-to-end: writing user stories, defining acceptance criteria, coordinating multinational stakeholders across security and compliance boundaries, and shipping autonomous feature sets through a GitOps rollout. I also unblocked an infrastructure-level issue independently that engineers had been unable to resolve for over a year, delivering it in a week. Technical fluency is not something I claim abstractly; it is how I protect a sprint from becoming hostage to dependency delays.

On the AI tooling dimension: I use Claude, Copilot, and n8n-based agentic workflows as daily instruments, not as experiments. I have already built grooming automation, status-summary pipelines, and LLM-assisted acceptance-criteria generators for my own delivery work. The posting asks the Product Owner to automate the mechanical layer of the role so judgment time increases. That is not a future aspiration for me – it is how I already operate.

The Qcrypt AG chapter of my career – where I co-founded a quantum-secure encryption product and served as deputy IT security officer – means I understand intuitively why Wire's security posture shapes every feature trade-off. I do not need to be convinced that "ship with the bug or fix it first" looks different when the product is used by intelligence agencies than when it is used by a consumer app.

I would welcome a conversation about the scope and the team. I am based in Berlin and available on four weeks' notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of cross-functional delivery experience, spanning AI and data platforms, regulated healthcare and insurance environments, government defence programmes, and founder-stage company building. Comfortable owning a backlog under pressure, running all Scrum rituals, and coaching teams toward genuine agile maturity rather than process compliance. AI-native by habit: Claude, Copilot, and n8n-based automation are part of my daily delivery toolkit. Technical fluency – Kubernetes, Python, REST APIs, GitOps – is real and operational, not ornamental.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership and sprint discipline in cross-functional teams

- Writing clear epics, user stories, and acceptance criteria under ambiguity
 - Facilitating refinement, planning, demos, and retrospectives
 - AI-native ticket drafting, status reporting, and grooming automation
 - Coaching teams toward self-organisation and agile maturity
 - Dependency coordination across scopes and disciplines
 - Trade-off judgment on ship-vs-fix decisions with engineering and product leadership
 - Security and compliance product thinking in regulated environments
 - Technical fluency sufficient to protect sprint scope with credibility
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager – AI Data Transformation (FCAS, European Defence Programme)

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout
 - Led a cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA across multinational stakeholder groups
 - Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
 - Unblocked an infrastructure-level issue in OpenShift independently – a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year, delivered in one week
 - Designed full data provenance, audit trail, and transparency concepts meeting government-grade compliance requirements
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FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager – Public Data Analytics Platform (Arbeitsmarktmonitor)

- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin workflows
 - Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV), covering compliance, governance, and data lineage
 - Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
 - Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
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EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager – InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability after a team in crisis: split a bloated 17-person group into smaller, effective Scrum units and introduced clear ownership and deputy structures
 - Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices that had collapsed under delivery pressure
 - Regained client trust through structured communication and weekly product workshops; reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure
 - Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
 - Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
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CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner – Mobile Healthcare App

- Led full delivery of a mobile-first pilot app for hospital patients across iOS and Android
 - Delivered core flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport scheduling, chat, and patient document storage
 - Coordinated CGM interface integration into hospital information system workflows under tight deadlines
 - Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external databases
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder and Product Owner – Quantum-Secure Encryption

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption features on a one-time-pad and true-RNG hardware stack
- USP: enterprise-grade quantum-secure encryption, operational in under two minutes, requiring no technical knowledge from the end user
- Served as deputy IT security officer; owned attack vector analysis and compliance posture
- English-language product promotion on record: youtube.com/watch?v=nt06f71lgfE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO – Group P2P Payments

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone; handled PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

ADDITIONAL EARLIER ROLES

- COVID-19 Data Platform, Bundesdruckerei (2021): Product Owner on RKI projects DIM and DESH; secure data structures and identity management
- AOK Health Insurance / ITSCare (2019–2020): Proxy Product Owner; Shopware webshop migration with complex catalogue/API integration and customisable approval policies
- Enercon (2019): Project Lead; full IT modernisation of a specialist manufacturing site
- Smart Soil Technologies (2016–2021): Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR across multiple phases; digital tooling, financial planning, investor relations

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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